Pāḷi Grammar Summary

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Introduction

About this Grammar Guide

This is a simplified grammar guide designed to accompany the Pāḷi texts used in this workshop. It aims to be clear, accessible, and beginner-friendly, without assuming any prior knowledge of grammar.

The explanations are intentionally succinct and kept as brief as possible without unnecessary elaboration, and therefore are not complete or comprehensive.
Hopefully, the explanations are still accurate and helpful, despite being short and incomplete. Students are encouraged to consult more detailed grammar references for a full and precise explanation of specific topics.

In this guide, only the most common grammatical forms will be presented, along with their most frequent endings, especially those relevant to the texts selected for this workshop.
For a more comprehensive overview, please refer to the detailed grammar summary handout.

Mor Ifrah

Pāḷi Phonetics

The Pāḷi alphabet consists of 41 letters/sounds: 8 vowels and 33 consonants.

sarā (vowels): a ā i ī u ū e o ṃ

ṃ (niggahīta) with: a, i, u. Examples: dhamma → dhamm**aṃ** | sati → sat**iṃ** | uju → uj**uṃ** |

- Vowel Length: A long vowel is pronounced twice as long as a short vowel.

Examples: b**a**la, b**ā**la | s**i**ri, p**ī**ti | k**u**la, m**ū**la | **e**k**o**, c**e**t**o** |

e and **o** are pronounced short before double consonants: m**e**ttā, pām**o**jja

Consonants:

(vāta = air; ghosa = voice)

	✗ vāta ✗ ghosa	✓ vāta ✗ ghosa	✗ vāta ✓ ghosa	✓ vāta ✓ ghosa	nāsikā nasal
kaṇṭhaja guttural	k	kh	g	gh	ṅ
tāluja palatal	c	ch	j	jh	ñ
muddhaja retroflex	ṭ	ṭh	ḍ	ḍh	ṇ
dantaja dental	t	th	d	dh	n
oṭṭhaja labial	p	ph	b	bh	m

antaṭṭha (semi-vowel): y r l v

sakāra (sibilant): s

hakāra (letter h): h

ḷ ḷh

Exercise 1: Distinguish between the aspirated vs. unaspirated letters

(ka vs. kha; ga vs. gha; ca vs. cha; etc.)

karaṇa	(doing)	khanti	(forbearance)	gata	(gone)	ghara	(house)
canda	(moon)	chanda	(desire)	jāti	(birth)	jhāna	
vaṭṭa	(round)	raṭṭha	(kingdom)	caṇḍa	(wild, cruel)	vuḍḍha	(old man)
sattā	(beings)	satthā	(teacher)	dāna	(donation)	dhana	(wealth)
pana	(but)	phala	(fruit)	bala	(strength)	bhava	(becoming)

Geminate Consonants:

- Double consonants should be pronounced.

Exx. ariyo aṭṭh'aṅgiko maggo
dhamma-cakka-ppavattana-sutta
vijjā-caraṇa-sampanno
anuttaraṃ puññā-kkhettaṃ lokassa

Exercise 2: Practice pronouncing the double consonant sounds

cakka	book cover	viññāṇa	in New York	adinnādāna	unnecessary	dhamma	calm men
bhagga	big girl	sutta	sweet talk	sappurisa	cheap potato	pallaṅka	tall lady
anicca	such changes	attha	not tall	mahapphala	top pair	seyyo	say yes
ajja	good job	sadda	mid-day	sabba	grab-bag	dassana	yes sir

Stress Accent:

- The default position for the stress accent is the "pre-penultimate" syllable:

exx. sa-ra-ṇa ti-ra-ta-na
vi-na-ya ca-ra-ti
pu-ri-sa ga-ma-na
vi-ca-ra-ṇa su-ga-ta

However, if the penultimate syllable is “heavy” (by having a long vowel or being followed by two consonants), the stress accent shifts to it:

Exx. sa-ra-**ṇe**-su
sam-**bu**-ddho
sam-**pa**-nno

Practice:

itiʻpi so bhagavā: arahaṃ, sammā-sambuddho, vijjā-caraṇa-sampanno, sugato, loka-vidū, anuttaro purisa-damma-sārathi, satthā deva-manussānaṃ, buddho, bhagavā”ti.

Pāḷi Grammar Basics

Verb Conjugation
(Present Tense Indicative)

gacchati – ***goes***

Person	Singular Pronouns	Singular Conjugation	Translation
3rd	so / sā	gaccha**ti**	he / she goes
2nd	tvaṃ	gaccha**si**	you go
1st	ahaṃ	gacch**āmi**	I go
	Plural Pronouns	Plural Conjugation	
3rd	te / tā	gaccha**nti**	they go
2nd	tumhe	gaccha**tha**	you (all) go
1st	mayaṃ	gacch**āma**	we go

passati – *sees*

Person	Singular Pronouns	Singular Conjugation	Translation
3rd	so / sā	passa**ti**	he / she sees
2nd	tvaṃ	passa**si**	you see
1st	ahaṃ	pass**āmi**	I see
	Plural Pronouns	Plural Conjugation	
3rd	te / tā	passa**nti**	they see
2nd	tumhe	passa**tha**	you (all) see
1st	mayaṃ	pass**āma**	we see

The Case System – Noun Inflection

A simplified chart of the Pali cases with examples

Masculine nouns, ending in 'a': **buddha**

Case		Singular	Plural	Definition	Example in a sentence (sing.)
1	Nominative	buddh**o**	buddh**ā**	The subject of the sentence; the person or thing doing the action.	**buddho** teaches the Dhamma. **buddho** is our teacher.
2	Accusative	buddh**aṃ**	buddh**e**	The direct object of the action.	He sees **buddhaṃ**. She asks **buddhaṃ**.
3	Instrumental	buddh**ena**	buddh**ehi**	The instrument by which an action is done. (Prepositions: **by, with, through**)	The Dhamma is taught **buddhena**. / The monk converses **buddhena**.
4	Dative	buddh**āya** / buddh**assa**	buddh**ānaṃ**	The indirect object, the person to whom an action is done; "the recipient"; indicates the purpose and benefit. (Prep.: **to, for**)	He gave alms-food **buddhāya**. / They presented a question **buddhassa**.
5	Ablative	buddh**ā** / **smā** / **mhā** / **to**	buddh**ehi**	Indicates separation, movement, origination, and comparison. (Prep.: **from, because, than**)	He heard the Dhamma **buddhā**. / We received the Dhamma **buddhasmā**.
6	Genitive	buddh**assa**	buddh**ānaṃ**	Expresses possession and ownership (**of**)	These are the teachings **buddhassa**.
7	Locative	buddh**e** / **smiṃ**	buddh**esu**	The place or time of action; "reference" (**in, on, above,** etc., **regarding, about,** etc.)	We have confidence **buddhe**. / There are wonderful qualities **buddhasmiṃ**.
	Vocative	buddh**a**	buddh**ā**	Used when addressing someone.	Lord **buddha**, please teach us.

Practicing the Cases

Nominative & Accusative

Word order: Subject – Object – Verb

puriso gāmaṃ gacchati.	
Buddho Ānandaṃ bhāsati.	
Ānando Buddhaṃ pucchati.	
janā saccaṃ bhāsanti.	
puriso rukkhaṃ passati.	
Buddho purise deseti.	
tumhe dhammaṃ paṭipajjatha.	
Ānando samaṇe passati.	
tvaṃ kammaṃ karosi.	
mayaṃ dānaṃ dadāma.	
thero rāgaṃ pajahati.	
rāgo sokaṃ janeti.	
mayaṃ paṇḍitaṃ gacchāma.	
so pāpaṃ na karoti.	
sāvakā kilese pajahanti.	
paṇḍitā adosaṃ bhāventi.	
adoso pamodaṃ janeti.	

- Verbs:
  gacchati (goes), **bhāsati** (speaks), **passati** (sees), **pucchati** (asks; questions), **deseti** (teaches), **paṭipajjati** (practices), **karoti** (makes; does), **dadāti** (gives), **pajahati** (abandons; lets go of), **janeti** (generates; produces), **bhāveti** (develops)

- Nouns & Adjectives:
  purisa (person), **gāma** (village), **jana** (people), **sacca** (truth), **rukkha** (tree), **samaṇa** (renunciant), **kamma** (action; work), **dāna** (gift; donation), **thera** (elder), **rāga** (lust; craving), **soka** (sorrow), **paṇḍita** (a wise one), **adosa** (non-hatred; kindness), **pamoda** (joy; happiness), **sāvaka** (disciple), **kilesa** (impurity; defilement), **na** (no; not), **pāpa** (bad action)

Instrumental & Ablative

sotena saddaṃ suṇāti.	
kāyena sucaritaṃ karotha.	
dhammo Buddhena pakāsito hoti.	
te dhammena rakkhitā honti.	
bhikkhu kusalehi dhammehi samannāgato.	
paṇḍito appamādena dhamma-dīpaṃ karoti.	
te pamādaṃ appamādena atikkamanti.	
tvaṃ akkodhena kodhaṃ jināsi.	
bhikkhu vihārā pakkamati.	
mettena cittena agāraṃ ajjhāvasati.	
saḷāyatana-paccayā phasso.	
upādāna-paccayā bhavo.	
sāvakā kilesehi parimuccanti.	
bhikkhunī pāpā cittaṃ saṃvarati.	
piyato jāyati soko.	
nissaggato jāyati pamodo.	
sā dukkhā parimuccati.	

- Verbs & Participles:
  suṇāti (hears), **pakāsita** (explained; made clear), **rakkhita** (protected), **hoti** (is; occurs), **pakkamati** (goes away; leaves), **ajjhāvasati** (lives), **samannāgata** (endowed), **jināti** (conquers), **parimuccati** (is fully liberated), **atikkamati** (transcends; goes beyond), **saṃvarati** (restrains), **jāyati** (is born)

- Nouns & Adjectives:
  sota (ear), **sadda** (sound), **kāya** (body), **sucarita** (good action), **vihāra** (monastery), **agāra** (house), **citta** (mind), **bhikkhu** (monk), **kusala** (wholesome), **paccaya** (condition; cause), **saḷāyatana** (six sense basis), **paccaya** (condition), **phassa** (contact; touch), **upādāna** (clinging), **bhava** (becoming; existence), **kodha** (anger), **pamāda** (heedlessness; negligence), **dīpa** (island), **appamāda** (heedfulness; diligence), **piya** (dear), **nissagga** (relinquishment; letting go), **bhikkhunī** (nun)

Dative & Genitive

namo Buddhāya.	
dhammo sukhāya saṃvattati.	
ko āhāro sati-sampajaññassa?	
ko āhāro nīvaraṇānaṃ?	
kiccho Buddhānaṃ uppādo hoti.	
sukho Buddhānaṃ uppādo.	
cittassa damatho sādhu.	
bhikkhu Buddhassa sāvako hoti.	
bhikkhu akusalānaṃ dhammānaṃ anuppādāya chandaṃ janeti.	
bhikkhu akusalānaṃ dhammānaṃ pahanāya chandaṃ janeti.	
dīgho bālānaṃ saṃsāro.	
dukkhaṃ ca dukkhassa nirodhaṃ ca deseti.	
atthi maggo dukkhassa samatikkamāya.	
atthi maggo sattānaṃ vimokkhāya.	
paṇḍitānaṃ saṃyogā n'atthi.	
eso jayo Buddhassa, Mārassa ca parājayo.	
so lokassa hitāya sukhāya dhammaṃ deseti.	

- Verbs:
  saṃvattati (leads), **deseti** (teaches), **atthi** (there is/are), **n'atthi** (there is/are no)

- Nouns & Adjectives (and other words):
  namo (homage), **sukha** (pleasure; happiness), **ka** (what), **ahāra** (nutriment), **sati** (awareness; mindfulness), **sampajañña** (clear comprehension), **nīvaraṇa** (hindrance), **damatha** (taming; training), **sādhu** (well; good), **kiccha** (difficult), **uppāda** (arising), **chanda** (desire), **pahāna** (abandoning), **dīgha** (long), **bāla** (fool; immature person), **jaya** (victory), **parājaya** (defeat), **ca** (and), **nirodha** (cessation), **āsava** (defilement), **khaya** (destruction; wearing away), **magga** (path), **satta** (a living being), **samatikkama** (transcending; going beyond), **vimokkha** (liberation), **saṃyoga** (fetter; bondage), **esa** (this), **loka** (world), **hita** (benefit; welfare)

Locative (& Vocative)

Bhagavā Jeta-vane viharati, Anāthapiṇḍikassa ārāme.	
sāvako Buddhassa sāsane abhinandati.	
te dhammasmiṃ anumodanti.	
sā kusalesu dhammesu saṇṭhahati.	
purisassa vihāre viharāmi.	
paṇḍitā appamāde pamodanti, ariyānaṃ gocare ratā.	
pamāde bhayaṃ passanti.	
kāmesu santoso na vijjati.	
vedanā kāyasmiṃ uppajjanti.	
Tathāgato, Bhikkhave, loke uppajjati.	
sā anicce dukkhaṃ samanupassati.	
tvaṃ dukkhe anattaṃ samanupassasi.	
paṇḍito saṅkhāresu nibbindati.	
Sāriputto rukkhassa mūle nisīdati.	
tā Tathāgate pasādaṃ paṭilabhanti.	
Tathāgate brahma-cariyaṃ vasāma.	
sādhu, Sāriputta, sādhu!	

- Verbs & Participles:
  viharati (dwells; lives), **abhinandati** (delights; finds pleasure), **anumodati** (rejoices; appreciates), **saṇṭhahati** (is established), **vasati** (lives), **pamodati** (is joyful; happy), **rata** (delighted),**vijjati** (is found; exists), **uppajjati** (arises), **samanupassati** (perceives; recognizes), **nibbindati** (becomes disenchanted), **nisīdati** (sits), **paṭilabhati** (obtains; gets; acquires)

- Nouns & Adjectives:
  ārāma (park; monastery), **sāsana** (teaching), **vana** (grove), **indriya** (sense faculties), **ariya** (noble), **gocara** (pasture; domain), **bhaya** (fear; danger), **kāma** (sensual pleasure; sense desire), **santosa** (contentment; satisfaction), **vedanā** (sensation; feeling), **kāya** (body), **saṅkhāra** (conditioned thing), **rukkha** (tree), **mūla** (root; foot), **pasāda** (faith; confidence), **brahma-cariya** (spiritual life), **anatta** (non-self), **Tathāgata** (designation of the Buddha)

Sandhi

- **Sandhi** (literally "joining" or "combination") refers to the phonetic changes that occur at the junction of words or syllables, typically when one word ends and the next begins. These adjustments make speech smoother and are very common.

- Sandhi also exists in English:
  he will → **he'll**; I am → **I'm**; do not → **don't**; is not → **isn't**; will not → **won't**

Some common sandhi sound changes include:

- **Final short vowel drops before a following vowel**
  - ten**a** + **u**pasaṅkami (there + approached) → ten'**u**pasaṅkami
  - pañc**a** + **i**māni (five + these) → pañc'imāni

- **Two short vowels merging into a long vowel** (a + a → ā, a + u → ū)
  - pāṇ**a** + **a**tipāta (life + destruction) → pāṇ'**ā**tipāta
  - dhamm**a** + **u**pasaṃhita (connected) → dhamm'**ū**pasaṃhita

- **The niggahita (ṃ) changes to match the following consonant**
  (*ṃ* becomes *ṅ* before k & g; *ñ* before c & j; *n* before t & d; *m* before p & b)
  - katama**ṃ** + ca (what + and) → katama**ñ**ca
  - ta**ṃ** + **a**pi (that + too/also) → ta**m'**pi

- **Doubling of consonants**
  - na + **p**ajānāti (does not + understand) → na**pp**ajānāti
  - pañca + **k**handhā (five + aggregates) → pañca**kk**handhā

- **Insertion of letters between vowels**
  - na + idaṃ (not + this) → na**y**idaṃ
  - adukkha + asukha (not painful + not pleasant) → adukkha**m**asukha

- **Change of letters**
  - s**u** + **a**kkhāto (well + explained) → s**vā**kkhāto
  - bo**dhi** + **a**ṅga (enlightenment + factor) → bo**jj**haṅga

Nouns

- A noun is a word that names a person, place, thing, or idea.
  In Pāḷi, as in English, nouns can refer to concrete objects (*kāya* – body),
  abstract concepts (*pāmojja* – joy), places (*ārāma* – park),
  or living beings (*purisa* – person).

Nouns in Pāḷi are classified according to:

- **Gender**: masculine, feminine, and neuter
- **Number**: singular and plural
- **Case**: eight grammatical cases – nominative, accusative, instrumental, dative, ablative, genitive, locative, and vocative

Neuter Nouns Ending in 'a': *sīla*

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	sīl**aṃ**	sīl**ā** / sīl**āni**
Accusative	sīl**aṃ**	sīl**āni** / sīl**e**
Instrumental	sīl**ena**	sīl**ehi**
Dative	sīla**ssa** / sīl**āya**	sīl**ānaṃ**
Ablative	sīl**ā** / sīla**to** / sīla**smā**	sīl**ehi**
Genitive	sīla**ssa**	sīl**ānaṃ**
Locative	sīl**amhi** / sīl**asmiṃ** / sīl**e**	sīl**esu**
Vocative	sīl**a**	sīl**ā** / sīl**āni**

Other Nouns in This Category:

sacca (truth), **dukkha** (pain; suffering), **sukha** (pleasure; happiness), **jīvita** (life), **karaṇa** (doing), **pariyodapana** (purifying; cleansing), **sāsana** (teaching), **saraṇa** (refuge), **citta** (mind), **bhaya** (fear), **dāna** (giving; generosity), **vera** (hatred), **pāmojja** (joy), **dassana** (seeing), **maṅgala** (blessing), **kamma** (action), **savaṇa** (hearing), **rūpa** (material form; visual object)

Feminine Nouns Ending in 'ā': *saddhā*

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	saddh**ā**	saddh**ā** / saddh**āyo**
Accusative	saddh**aṃ**	saddh**ā** / saddh**āyo**
Instrumental	saddh**āya**	saddh**āhi**
Dative	saddh**āya**	saddh**ānaṃ**
Ablative	saddh**āya** / saddh**āto**	saddh**āhi**
Genitive	saddh**āya**	saddh**ānaṃ**
Locative	saddh**āya** / saddh**āyaṃ**	saddh**āsu**
Vocative	saddh**a** / saddh**e**	saddh**ā** / saddh**āyo**

Other Nouns in This Category:
vedanā (sensation; feeling), **saññā** (perception), **paññā** (wisdom), **vācā** (speach), **mettā** (love; loving-kindness; goodwill), **bhāvanā** (development)

Feminine Nouns Ending in 'i': *sati*

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	sat**i**	sat**iyo** / sat**ī**
Accusative	sat**iṃ**	sat**iyo** / sat**ī**
Instrumental	sat**iyā**	sat**īhi**
Dative	sat**iyā**	sat**īnaṃ**
Ablative	sat**iyā** / sat**ito**	sat**īhi**
Genitive	sat**iyā**	sat**īnaṃ**
Locative	sat**iyā** / sat**iyaṃ**	sat**isu**
Vocative	sat**i**	sat**iyo** / sat**ī**

Other Nouns in This Category:
bodhi (enlightenment), **pīti** (rapture), **diṭṭhi** (view), **santuṭṭhi** (contentment)

Masculine Nouns Ending in 'u': *bhikkhu*

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	bhikkh**u**	bhikkh**ū**
Accusative	bhikkh**uṃ**	bhikkh**ū**
Instrumental	bhikkh**unā**	bhikkh**ūhi**
Dative	bhikkh**uno** / bhikkh**ussa**	bhikkh**ūnaṃ**
Ablative	bhikkh**uto** / bhikkh**unā**	bhikkh**ūhi**
Genitive	bhikkh**uno** / bhikkh**ussa**	bhikkh**ūnaṃ**
Locative	bhikkh**umhi** / bhikkh**usmiṃ**	bhikkh**ūsu**
Vocative	bhikkh**u**	bhikkh**ave** / bhikkh**avo**

Other Nouns in This Category:
guru (teacher), **hetu** (cause)

Masculine Agent Nouns Ending in 'ā': *satthā*

Case	Singular	Plural
Nominative	satth**ā**	satth**āro**
Accusative	satth**araṃ** / satth**āraṃ**	satth**āre** / satth**āro**
Instrumental	satth**ārā** / satth**unā**	satth**ārehi**
Dative	satth**uno** / satth**ussa**	satth**ānaṃ** / satth**ārānaṃ**
Ablative	bhikkh**uto** / bhikkh**unā**	satth**ārehi**
Genitive	satth**uno** / satth**ussa**	satth**ānaṃ** / satth**ārānaṃ**
Locative	satth**ari**	satth**āresu**
Vocative	satth**ā**	satth**āro**

Other Nouns in This Category:
dātā (giver), **netā** (leader), **kattā** (doer), **gantā** ("goer")

Pronouns

- A pronoun is a word that stands in place of a noun.
- Pronouns are also classified according to **gender, number,** and **case**.
- These are the main types of pronouns:
  - **Personal pronouns** refer to the speaker or others – **ahaṃ** (*I*), **tvaṃ** (*you*).
  - **Demonstrative pronouns** point to specific things – **ayaṃ** (*this*), **taṃ** (*that*).
  - **Relative pronouns** introduce relative clauses – **yo** (*which/who,* etc.).
  - **Interrogative pronouns** are used to ask questions – **ko**/**kiṃ** (*who? what? which?*).

Personal Pronouns: **ahaṃ** (*I*)

Case	First Person (I / we)		Second Person (you)	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	ahaṃ	mayaṃ / amhe	tvaṃ	tumhe
Accusative	mamaṃ / maṃ / me	amhākaṃ / amhe / no	tvaṃ	tumhe / vo
Instrumental	mayā / me	amhehi / no	tayā / te	tumhehi / vo
Dative	mama / mayhaṃ / me	amhākaṃ / no	tava / te	tumhākaṃ / vo
Ablative	mayā	amhehi	tayā	tumhehi
Genitive	mama / mayhaṃ / me	amhākaṃ / no	tava / te	tumhākaṃ / vo
Locative	mayi	amhesu	tayi	tumhesu

- In addition to meaning ***he*** or ***she***, the third-person pronoun can also function as a demonstrative, meaning ***it*** or ***that***, depending on the context:

Third Person (he / she / it)						
	Masculine (he, they / that, those)		**Neuter** (that, those)		**Feminine** (she, they / that, those)	
Case	**Singular**	**Plural**	**Singular**	**Plural**	**Singular**	**Plural**
Nominative	so	te	taṃ	tāni	sā	tā
Accusative	taṃ	te	taṃ	tāni	taṃ	tā
Instrumental	tena	tehi	tena	tehi	tāya	tāhi
Dative	tassa	tesaṃ	tassa	tesaṃ	tassā / tassāya	tāsaṃ
Ablative	tasmā / tamhā / tato	tehi	tasmā / tamhā / tato	tehi	tāya	tāhi
Genitive	tassa	tesaṃ	tassa	tesaṃ	tassā / tassāya	tāsaṃ
Locative	tasmiṃ	tesu	tasmiṃ	tesu	tassaṃ	tāsu

- These forms may be preceded by **e** (*eso*, *etaṃ*, etc.), adding some emphasis or indicating proximity.

Demonstrative Pronouns: ima *(this / these)*

Case	**Masculine**		**Neuter**		**Feminine**	
	Singular	**Plural**	**Singular**	**Plural**	**Singular**	**Plural**
Nominative	ayaṃ	ime	idaṃ / imaṃ	imāni / ime	ayaṃ	imā
Accusative	imaṃ	ime	idaṃ / imaṃ	imāni / ime	imaṃ	imā
Instrumental	iminā	imehi	iminā	imehi	imāya	imāhi
Dative	assa / imassa	imesaṃ	assa / imassa	imesaṃ	imāya / assā	imāsaṃ
Ablative	imamhā / imasmā	imehi	imamhā / imasmā	imehi	imāya	imāhi
Genitive	assa / imassa	imesaṃ	assa / imassa	imesaṃ	imāya / assā	imāsaṃ
Locative	imamhi / imasmiṃ	imesu	imamhi / imasmiṃ	imesu	imāyaṃ	imāsu

Relative Pronouns: **ya** *(which / that [which] / [one] who)*

- A **relative pronoun** is a word that introduces a **relative clause** — a part of the sentence that gives more information about a noun or pronoun.
  In English, relative pronouns include: **who, whom, which, that [which], whose**
- Pāḷi often pairs the relative pronoun ***ya*** with a demonstrative pronoun ***ta*** to link the two parts of the sentence. Where in English we might say:
  "The book that I read is good." A corresponding construction in Pāḷi would be something like: *"***That** *book* **which** *I read* — **that** *book is good."* (**ya** *book I read* — **ta** *book is good*).
  For example:
  - ***yaṃ*** aniccaṃ, ***taṃ*** dukkhaṃ [hoti].
    whatever is anicca, ***that*** is dukkha.
  - ***yo*** paṭicca-samuppādaṃ passati, ***so*** dhammaṃ passati.
    one who sees dependent origination, ***he*** sees the Dhamma.

The declension paradigm of the relative pronoun follows that of the **third-person pronoun above**, but with **"t"** replaced by **"y"**:

	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
Case	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	yo	ye	yaṃ	yāni	yā	yā
Accusative	yaṃ	ye	yaṃ	yāni	yaṃ	yā
Instrumental	yena	yehi	yena	yehi	yāya	yāhi
Dative	yassa	yesaṃ	yassa	yesaṃ	yassā / yassāya	yāsaṃ
Ablative	yasmā / yamhā / yato	yehi	yasmā / yamhā / yato	yehi	yāya	yāhi
Genitive	yassa	yesaṃ	yassa	yesaṃ	yassā / yassāya	yāsaṃ
Locative	yasmiṃ	yesu	yasmiṃ	yesu	yassaṃ	yāsu

Interrogative Pronouns: **ka** *(who? what? which?)*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	ko	ke	kaṃ / kiṃ	kāni / ke	kā	kā / kāyo
Accusative	kaṃ	ke	kaṃ / kiṃ	kāni / ke	kaṃ	kā / kāyo
Instrumental	kena	kehi	kena	kehi	kāya	kāhi
Dative	kassa / kissa	kesaṃ	kassa / kissa	kesaṃ	kassā / kāya	kāsānaṃ
Ablative	kasmā	kehi	kasmā	kehi	kāya	kāhi
Genitive	kassa / kissa	kesaṃ	kassa / kissa	kesaṃ	kassā / kāya	kāsānaṃ
Locative	kamhi / kasmiṃ	kesu	kamhi / kasmiṃ	kesu	kāya / kāyaṃ	kāsu

- ***katama*** (what? which?) is another common interrogative form, and it follows a similar declension pattern (katam**o**, katam**aṃ**, katam**ena**, etc.).

Adjectives (vant / ī / (i)ka)

An adjective is a word that describes a noun. It gives more information about the noun, such as its quality, quantity, or state (e.g., *big, short, kind*).

Besides straightforward adjectives like *anicca* (below), there are a few other common ways to form adjectives in Pāḷi. Very common are the ***vant/mant*** and ***ī*** types,
shown below in their declension patterns.

Another common way to form adjectives from nouns is by adding the suffix ***(i)ka***,
for example:

- *kāya* (body) → *kāy**ika*** (bodily)
- *cetas* (mind) → *cetas**ika*** (mental)
- *dhamma* → *dhamm**ika*** ("dhammic")

Unlike nouns, adjectives can take all three genders, and **must agree** (match) with the noun they describe in **gender, number, and case**. For example:

- *anicc**o** sańkhār**o*** – masculine, singular, nominative
- *anicc**aṃ** rūp**aṃ*** – neuter, singular, nominative/accusative
- *anicc**ā** vedan**ā*** – feminine, singular/plural, nominative

anicca – *impermanent*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	anicc**o**	anicc**ā**	anicc**aṃ**	anicc**āni**	anicc**ā**	anicc**ā**
Accusative	anicc**aṃ**	anicc**e**	anicc**aṃ**	anicc**āni**	anicc**aṃ**	anicc**ā**
Instrumental	anicc**ena**	anicc**ehi**	anicc**ena**	anicc**ehi**	anicc**āya**	anicc**āhi**
Dative	anicc**assa** / anicc**āya**	anicc**ānaṃ**	anicc**assa** / anicc**āya**	anicc**ānaṃ**	anicc**āya**	anicc**ānaṃ**
Ablative	anicca**to** / anicc**ā**	anicc**ehi**	anicc**ā**	anicc**ehi**	anicc**āya**	anicc**āhi**
Genitive	anicca**ssa**	anicc**ānaṃ**	anicca**ssa**	anicc**ānaṃ**	anicc**āya**	anicc**ānaṃ**
Locative	anicc**amhi** / anicc**e**	anicc**esu**	anicc**amhi** / anicc**e**	anicc**esu**	anicc**āya**	anicc**āsu**

vant/mant Possessive Adjective: sīlavā – *one who has sīla*; *virtuous*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	sīlav**ā** / sīlav**anto**	sīlav**antā** / sīlav**anto**	sīlav**antaṃ** / sīlav**aṃ**	sīlav**anti** / sīlav**antāni**	sīlav**atī**	sīlav**atī**
Accusative	sīlav**antaṃ**	sīlav**ante**	sīlav**antaṃ**	sīlav**anti** / sīlav**ante**	sīlav**atiṃ**	sīlav**atī**
Instrumental	sīlav**atā** / sīlav**antena**	sīlav**antehi**	sīlav**atā** / sīlav**antena**	sīlav**antehi**	sīlav**atiyā**	sīlav**atīhi**
Dative	sīlav**ato** / sīlav**antassa**	sīlav**ataṃ** / sīlav**antānaṃ**	sīlav**ato** / sīlav**antassa**	sīlav**ataṃ** / sīlav**antānaṃ**	sīlav**atiyā**	sīlav**atīnaṃ**
Ablative	sīlav**atā** / sīlav**antā**	sīlav**antehi**	sīlav**atā** / sīlav**antā**	sīlav**antehi**	sīlav**atiyā**	sīlav**atīhi**
Genitive	sīlav**ato** / sīlav**antassa**	sīlav**ataṃ** / sīlav**antānaṃ**	sīlav**ato** / sīlav**antassa**	sīlav**ataṃ** / sīlav**antānaṃ**	sīlav**atiyā**	sīlav**atīnaṃ**
Locative	sīlav**ati** / sīlav**ante**	sīlav**antesu**	sīlav**ati** / sīlav**ante**	sīlav**antesu**	sīlav**atiyā**	sīlav**atīsu**

Other ***vant/mant*** Adjectives: **bhagavā**, **paññavā** (wise), **sutavā** (learned), **satimā** (aware)

ī Adjective: ātāpī – *ardent*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	ātāpī	ātāp**ino** / ātāpī	ātāp**i** / ātāp**iṃ**	ātāpī	ātāp**inī**	ātāp**iniyo** / ātāp**inī**
Accusative	ātāp**iṃ**	ātāp**ino** / ātāpī	ātāp**i** / ātāp**iṃ**	ātāpī	ātāp**iṃ**	ātāp**iniyo** / ātāp**inī**
Instrumental	ātāp**inā**	ātāp**īhi**	ātāp**inā**	ātāp**īhi**	ātāp**iniyā**	ātāp**īhi**
Dative	ātāp**ino**	ātāp**īnaṃ**	ātāp**ino**	ātāp**īnaṃ**	ātāp**iniyā**	ātāp**īnaṃ**
Ablative	ātāp**inā**	ātāp**īhi**	ātāp**inā**	ātāp**īhi**	ātāp**iniyā**	ātāp**īhi**
Genitive	ātāp**ino**	ātāp**īnaṃ**	ātāp**ino**	ātāp**īnaṃ**	ātāp**iniyā**	ātāp**inīnaṃ**
Locative	ātāp**imhi**	ātāp**isu**	ātāp**imhi**	ātāp**isu**	ātāp**iniyā**	ātāp**inīsu**

Other *ī* Adjectives: **anupassī** (observing), **sukhī** (happy), **gāmī** (going), **vādī** (speaking)

Compounds

A compound is a combination of two or more words that are joined together to create a specific meaning.

In a compound, usually only the final word takes a case ending, while the other words remain in their stem form.

There are 6 types of compounds in Pāḷi:

tappurisa – Case Compound

- A compound in which the first word is related to the second by a **case relationship**, such as genitive (*of*), instrumental (*by/with*), dative (*to/for*), etc.

English Examples	Pāḷi Examples
tabletop → top **of** a table	buddha-dhamma → the teaching **of** the Buddha
sunlight → light **of** the sun	mettā-bhāvanā → the cultivation **of** mettā
toothbrush → brush **for** teeth	anicca-saññā → the perception **of** anicca
book-learning → learning **from** books	buddha-bhāsita → spoken **by** the Buddha
bookcase → case **for** books	attha-saṃhita → connected **with** benefit
handwriting → writing **with** the hand	arañña-gata → gone **to** the forest
	arañña-vāsa → living **in** the forest

dvanda – Copulative Compound

- A compound that joins two or more items in a **list** and is usually translated with "**and**."

English Examples	Pāḷi Examples
bitter-sweet → bitter **and** sweet	dhamma-vinaya → teaching **and** discipline
push-pull → push **and** pull	nāma-rūpa → mind **and** matter
on-off → on **and** off	ñāṇa-dassana → knowledge **and** vision
	samudaya-vaya → arising **and** passing away

kammadhāraya – Adjectival Compound

- A compound in which both parts **refer to the same thing**;
  the second word is usually a noun, and the first qualifies it, like an adjective.

English Examples	Pāḷi Examples
blackbird	dukkha-vedanā → painful feeling
smartphone	kusala-dhamma → wholesome quality
loudspeaker	mahā-purisa → great man
blueberry	piya-vācā → kind words
small-talk	brahma-cariya → spiritual life
hardcopy	sammā-diṭṭhi → right view

bahubbīhi – Adjectival Compound

- A compound that describes something **external to itself** and is often used **adjectivally**.

English Examples	Pāḷi Examples
sweetheart [**person**]	maraṇa-dhammo [**satto**] → [**a being**] who is subject to death
redhead [**girl**]	passaddha-kāyo [**bhikkhu**] → [**a bhikkhu**] whose body is tranquil
bare-foot [**man**]	mahā-paññō [**buddho**] → [**the Buddha**] who has great wisdom
big-mouth [**person**]	vipariṇāma-dhammā [**vedanā**] → [**a sensation**] having the nature of change
laptop [**computer**]	kamma-dāyādo [**amhi**] → [**I am**] the heir of [my] actions
two-car [**garage**]	gutta-dvāro [**bhkkhu**] → [**a bhikkhu**] whose sense doors are guarded

abyayībhāva – Adverbial Compound

- An **indeclinable** compound whose first member is typically an adverb or prefix, and which **functions as an adverb**.

English Examples	Pāḷi Examples
(lives) uptown	yathā-bhūtaṃ → in accordance with reality; as it is
(sits) outside	anu-pubbaṃ → gradually
(goes) underground	paccattaṃ (paṭi + atta) → personally
(runs) superfast	ajjhattaṃ (adhi + atta) → internally

digu – Numerical Compound

- A compound that begins with a number and is followed by a noun.

English Examples	Pāḷi Examples
bicycle	dve-paccaya → two conditions
tripod	catu-sacca → four truths
	pañca-kkhandha → five aggregates
	pañca-sīla → five precepts

Verbs

A verb is a word that expresses an action, occurrence, or state of being.
Verbs in Pāḷi are conjugated primarily to show:

- **Tense** (present, past, future)
- **Person** (first, second, or third)
- **Number** (singular or plural)
- **Mood** (indicative, optative, imperative, etc.)
- **Voice** (active or passive)

Each verb has a root, which is modified with various endings and sometimes prefixes to create different forms.

The Optative (**eyya / e**)

Use:

The Optative generally expresses:

- Hypothetical or conditional situations
- Polite requests, suggestions, or instructions
- Wishes or hopes

To translate it, we usually use auxiliary verbs such as **would, could, might, may,** and **should**.
For example: so/sā **gaccheyya** – *he/she **could go / should go***, etc.

Formation:

The Optative is formed by adding the following endings to the stem (base) of the verb (*gacchati → gaccha*).

	Singular	Plural
3rd person (he / they)	gacch**eyya** / gacch**e**	gacch**eyyuṃ**
2nd person (you)	gacch**eyyāsi** / gacch**e**	gacch**etha** / gacch**eyyātha**
1st person (I / we)	gacch**eyyāmi** / gacch**eyyaṃ** gacch**e**	gacch**eyyāma**

Examples:

1. yo ca vassa-sataṃ **jīve**...
   One **may live** a hundred years... (jīvati), (p. 7)
2. na **haneyya**...
   One **should** not **kill**... (hanati), (p. 7)
3. mā **'vamaññetha** puññassa...
   One **should** not **underestimate** the good... (avamaññati), (p. 8)
4. **anussaretha** sambuddhaṃ...
   You **should recollect** the Buddha... (sarati), (p. 12)
5. atha dhammaṃ **sareyyātha**.
   Then you **should recall** the Dhamma... (sarati), (p. 12)
6. n'āhaṃ evaṃ **vadeyyaṃ**...
   I **would** not **say**... (vadati), (p.16)
7. ahitāya dukkhāya **saṃvatteyya**...
   Would lead to harm and suffering... (saṃvattati), (p.16)
8. vacī-pakopaṃ **rakkheyya**.
   One **should guard** against angry speech... (rakkhati), (p. 21)
9. vācāya sucaritaṃ **care**.
   One **should practice** good conduct in speech... (carati), (p. 21)
10. yaṃ tumhe ... **vihareyyātha**...
    That you ... **whould dwell**... (viharati), (p. 24)
11. vo pare ... **vadeyyuṃ**...
    Others **may say** to you... (vadati), (p. 25)
12. yaṃ **passe** vajja-dassinaṃ...
    One **should regard** the one who sees your faults... (passati), (p. 27)
13. niggayha-vādiṃ medhāviṃ, tādisaṃ paṇḍitaṃ **bhaje**.
    One **should associate** with such a wise one... (bhajati), (p. 27)
14. cittaṃ **rakkhetha** medhāvī...
    Let the wise one **guard** the mind... (rakkhati), (p. 32)
15. sammā-paṇihitaṃ cittaṃ, seyyaso naṃ tato **kare**.
    A mind directed rightly **could do** more good for oneself than that... (karoti), (p. 33)
16. yaṃ nūn'āhaṃ ... **vihareyyaṃ**...
    What if I **were to dwell**... (viharati), (p. 38)

17. na idaṃ rūpaṃ ābādhāya **saṃvatteyya**...
    This material form **would** not **lead** to affliction... (saṃvattati), (p. 46)

18. jano **hareyya** vā, **ḍaheyya** vā...
    People **were to carry off** ... or **were to burn**... (harati, ḍahati), (p. 52)

19. pāpakā akusalā dhammā **anvāssaveyyuṃ**.
    Bad unwholesome states **might invade** [him]... (anvāssavati), (p. 55)

20. puṭṭho ca, na **sampāyeyya**.
    And if questioned, he **could** not **reply**... (sampāyati), (p. 56)

21. attānaṃ **niveseyya** yathā bhūri pavaḍḍhati...
    One **should conduct** oneself so that wisdom increases... (niveseti), (p. 60)

22. tam enaṃ cakkhumā puriso **passeyya**...
    A man with good sight **would observe** it... (passati), (p. 71)

23. sakkāraṃ n'**ābhinandeyya**...
    Should not **seek delight** in honors... (abhinandati), (p. 88)

24. sato, bhikkhave, bhikkhu **vihareyya** sampajāno.
    A bhikkhu **should dwell** aware and clearly comprehending... (viharati), (p. 93)

25. ātāpinī, pahitattā **vihareyyaṃ**.
    I might dwell ... ardent, and resolute... (viharati), (p. 108)

26. ye kho tvaṃ, gotami, dhamme **jāneyyāsi**...
    Gotamī, those things of which you **might know**... (jānāti), (p. 108)

27. gotami, **dhāreyyāsi**...
    You **should bear in mind**, Gotamī... (dhāreti), (p. 108)

28. **adhigacche** padaṃ santaṃ...
    [The bhikkhu ...] **would attain** the peaceful state... (adhigacchati), (p. 110)

29. sace hi so ... mettena cittena **phareyya**...
    If he **were to pervade** ... with a mind of mettā... (pharati), (p. 113)

The Absolutive (tvā / ya)

Use:

The Absolutive (also known as the Gerund) mainly expresses an action that has been **completed prior to** the action of the main verb in the sentence.

To translate it literally, we usually use "**having**" + a **past participle**.
For example: **gantvā** – ***having gone***.

Formation:

The absolutive is **not conjugated**. It is formed by adding the endings ***(i)tvā / (i)tvāna / ya*** to the root (*gacchati* → √*gam*) or stem (base) of the verb, often with some changes to the root (√*ga**m*** → *ga**n**tvā*).

Examples:

1. attānaṃ upamaṃ **katvā**...
   (literally) **Having made** a comparison to oneself... (karoti), (p. 7)
2. **upasaṅkamitvā**, bhagavantaṃ **abhivādetvā**...
   Having approached, **having paid homage** to the Blessed One... (upasaṅkamati, abhivādeti), (p. 13)
3. ariya-sāvako adinn'ādānaṃ **pahāya**...
   The noble disciple, **having abandoned** the taking of what is not given... (pajahati), (p. 15)
4. musā-vādaṃ **pahāya**...
   Having abandoned false speech... (pajahati), (p. 15)
5. aparimāṇānaṃ sattānaṃ abhayaṃ **datvā**...
   Having given to an immeasurable number of beings freedom from fear... (dadāti), (p. 20)
6. vacī-duccaritaṃ **hitvā**...
   Having abandoned verbal misconduct... (jahati), (p. 21)
7. tañ ca puggalaṃ mettā-sahagatena cetasā **pharitvā** viharissāma...
   We shall dwell **having pervaded** that person with a mind suffused with mettā... (pharati), (p. 25)
8. etaṃ puggalaṃ akusalā **vuṭṭhāpetvā**...
   Having made this person **emerge** from the unwholesome... (vuṭṭhāpeti, causative), (p. 27)
9. bhagavato **sutvā**, bhikkhū dhāressanti.
   Having heard it from the Blessed One, the bhikkhus will remember it... (suṇāti), (p. 35)

10. bhikkhu cakkhunā rūpaṃ **disvā**...
    A bhikkhu, **having seen** a material form with the eye... (passati), (p. 55)
11. sotena saddaṃ **sutvā**...
    Having heard a sound with the ear... (suṇāti), (p. 55)
12. etaṃ dvedhā-pathaṃ **ñatvā**...
    Having known these two paths... (jānāti), (p. 60)
13. so vedanā **pariññāya**...
    Having fully understood vedanā... (parijānāti), (p. 64)
14. evam etaṃ **abhiññāya**...
    Having known it thus... (abijānāti), (p. 88)
15. sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sāraṇīyaṃ **vītisāretvā**...
    Having concluded their greetings and cordial talk... (vītisāreti), (p. 90)
16. ujuṃ kāyaṃ **paṇidhāya**...
    Having set (their) body erect... (paṇidahati), (p. 95)
17. satiṃ **upaṭṭhapetvā**...
    Having established awareness... (patiṭṭhāpeti), (p. 95)

The Imperative (tu)

Use:

The Imperative is mainly used to express:

With the 2nd person:

- Requests, commands, or instructions: **gacchāhi** – ***go!***

With the 1st and 3rd person:

- Wishes and hopes (somewhat similar in meaning to the optative): **gacchantu** – ***may they go***.

Formation:

The Imperative is formed by adding the following endings to the stem of the verb.

	Singular	Plural
3rd person (he / they)	gaccha**tu**	gaccha**ntu**
2nd person (you)	gaccha / gacchā**hi**	gaccha**tha**
1st person (I / we)	gacchā**mi**	gacchā**ma**

Examples With the Second Person:

1. akusalaṃ, bhikkhave, **pajahatha**.
   Bhikkhus, **abandon** the unwholesome!... (pajahati), (p. 16)
2. kusalaṃ, bhikkhave, **bhāvetha**.
   Bhikkhus, **develop** the wholesome!... (bhāveti), (p. 16)
3. tena hi, bhikkhave, **suṇātha**, sādhukaṃ manasi **karotha**...
   Then **listen,** bhikkhus, and **attend** closely... (suṇāti, karoti), (p. 35)
4. yaṃ, bhikkhave, na tumhākaṃ, taṃ **pajahatha**.
   Bhikkhus, that which is not yours, **let go** of it... (pajahati), (p. 52)
5. **jhāyatha**, bhikkhave, mā pamād'**attha**.
   Meditate, bhikkhus, do not **be** negligent... (jhāyati, atthi), (p. 92)
6. tasmātih'ānanda, atta-dīpā **viharatha**...
   Therefore, Ānanda, **dwell** with yourselves as your own island... (viharati), (p. 100)

7. tattha ca nimittaṃ **gaṇhāhi**.
   And **take up** the object there... (gaṇhati), (p. 107)
8. appamādena **sampādetha**...
   Strive without heedlessness **to attain** [the goal]... (sampādeti), (p. 109)

Examples With the First and Third Person:

9. evaṃ me rūpaṃ **hotu**...
   Let my material form **be** thus... (hoti), (p. 46)
10. upāsakaṃ maṃ bhagavā **dhāretu**.
    Let the Blessed One **remember** me as a lay follower... (dhāreti), (p. 24)
11. bhagavā saṃkhittena dhammaṃ **desetu**.
    Let the Blessed One **teach** me the Dhamma in brief... (deseti), (p. 108)
12. sabbe bhadrāni **passantu**.
    May all beings **meet (see)** with good fortune... (passati), (p. 114)
13. ahaṃ avero **homi**.
    May I be free of hatred... (hoti), (p. 116)
14. ... averā **hontu**.
    May [my mother ... and everyone] **be** free of hatred... (hoti), (p. 116)
15. sukhī attānaṃ **pariharantu**.
    May they keep themselves happy... (pariharati), (p. 116)
16. sabbe sattā **bhavantu** sukhit'attā.
    May they be inwardly happy!... (bhavati), (p. 117)
17. **bhavatu** sabba-maṅgalaṃ.
    May there be a true blessing for all beings... (bhavati), (p. 117)

The Infinitive (tuṃ)

Use:

The Infinitive mainly expresses the **purpose, ability, or suitability** of an action and depends on the main verb of the sentence.
It **does not indicate time**, and is usually translated as *"to [verb]"* in English.
For example: **gantuṃ** – ***to go***, **passituṃ** – ***to see***.

Formation:

The Infinitive is **not conjugated**. It is formed by adding the ending ***(i)tuṃ*** to the root. (*gacchati* → √*gam*) or stem of the verb (*gacchati* → *gaccha*), often with some changes to the root.

Examples:

1. sakkā, bhikkhave, akusalaṃ **pajahituṃ**.
   It is possible **to abandon** the unwholesome... (pajahati), (p. 16)
2. sakkā, bhikkhave, kusalaṃ **bhāvetuṃ**.
   It is possible **to develop** the wholesome... (bhāveti), (p. 16)
3. sakkomi c'āhaṃ etaṃ puggalaṃ ... kusale **patiṭṭhāpetuṃ**.
   I am able **to establish** this person in the wholesome... (patiṭṭhāpeti), (p. 27)
4. atha kho māro ... bhayaṃ ... **uppādetu'**kāmo, samādhimhā **cāvetu'**kāmo...
   Then Māra desiring **to arouse** fear ... desiring **to make** her **fall away** from concentration... (uppādeti, cāveti), (p. 50)
5. anujānāmi, bhikkhave, imāni ... mettena cittena **pharituṃ**.
   I enjoin you, bhikkhus, **to pervade** these ... with a mind of mettā... (pharati), (p. 113)

The Past Tense (Aorist)

Use:

The Aorist is mainly used as a past tense in Pāḷi, similar to how the past tense is used in English.
For example: so/sā **agacchi** – *he/she* ***went****.*

There are several sets of endings for the Aorist, but here they are grouped together selectively to show the most common forms, especially those found in the texts selected for this workshop.

Formation:

The Aorist is formed by adding the following endings to the root (*gacchati* → √*gam*),
or stem of the verb (*gaccha*). In some cases, a short **a** is added at the beginning.

	Singular	Plural
3rd person (he / they)	(a)gacch**i** / (a)gam**i** / **a**gam**āsi**	gacch**iṃsu** / gacch**uṃ** / (a)gam**aṃsu** / gam**iṃsu** / gam**uṃ**
2nd person (you)	(a)gacch**i** / (a)gam**i** / **a**gam**āsi**	gacch**ittha** / gam**ittha** / **a**gam**attha**
1st person (I / we)	(a)gacch**iṃ** / gam**iṃ** / **a**gam**āsim**	gacch**imha** / gam**imha**

Examples:

1. mahānāmo sakko yena bhagavā ten' **upasaṅkami**...
   Mahānāma the Sakyan **approached** the Blessed One... (upasaṅkamati), (p. 13)
2. mahānāmo sakko bhagavantaṃ etad **avoca**...
   Mahānāma the Sakyan **said** this to the Blessed One... (vacati (irregular)), (p. 13)
3. ekam antaṃ **nisīdi**...
   He sat down to one side... (nisīdati), (p. 17)
4. byantameva naṃ **akāsiṃ**....
   I **put** (**made**) an end to it... (karoti), (p. 39)
5. bhikkhū bhagavato bhāsitaṃ **abhinanduṃ**...
   The bhikkhus **delighted** in the Blessed One's statement... (abhinandati), (p. 49)

6. gāthāya **ajjhabhāsi**...
   He addressed her in verse... (ajjhabhāsati), (p. 50)
7. māro pāpimā ... dukkhī dummano tatthev' **antaradhāyi**...
   Then Māra the Evil One ... sad and disappointed, **disappeared** right there... (antaradhāyati), (p. 50)
8. tatra kho bhagavā bhikkhū **āmantesi**...
   There the Blessed One **addressed** the bhikkhus... (āmanteti), (p. 57)
9. bhikkhūnaṃ anupādāya āsavehi cittāni **vimucciṃsu**...
   The minds of the bhikkhus **were liberated** from the āsavas by nonclinging... (vimuccati), (p. 58)
10. anupādāya āsavehi cittaṃ **vimucci**...
    [Bāhiya's] mind **was liberated** from the āsavas by non-clinging.... (vimuccati), (p. 59)
11. antam **akāsi** dukkhassa...
    He **put** (**made**) an end to dukkha... (karoti), (p. 64)
12. te bhikkhū bhagavato **paccassosuṃ**...
    Those bhikkhus **replied** to the Blessed One... (paṭissuṇāti), (p. 66)
13. sambahulā bhikkhū yena bhagavā ten' **upasaṅkamiṃsu**...
    A number of bhikkhus **approached** the Blessed One... (upasaṅkamati), (p. 113)
14. te bhikkhū bhagavantaṃ etad **avocuṃ**...
    Those bhikkhus **said** to the Blessed One... (vacati), (p. 113)
15. anuttaro dhamma-varaṃ **adesayi**...
    The unsurpassed one **taught** the excellent Dhamma... (deseti), (p. 115)

The Future Tense (issa)

Use:

The Future Tense in Pāḷi expresses the simple future, similar to how it's used and understood in English. For example: so/sā **gacchissati** – *he/she **will go**.*

Formation:

The future is formed by adding the affix ***(i)ssa*** to the stem of the verb (*gacchati* → *gaccha*), or its root (*gacchati* → √*gam*), followed by the present indicative endings.

	Singular	Plural
3rd person (he / they)	gacch**issati**	gacch**issanti**
2nd person (you)	gacch**issasi**	gacch**issatha**
1st person (I / we)	gacch**issāmi**	gacch**issāma**

Examples:

1. na maṃ taṃ **āgamissati**.
   That **will** not **come** to me... (āgacchati), (p. 8)
2. hit'ānukampī ca **viharissāma** metta-cittā...
   Compassionate for their welfare, **we shall dwell** with a mind of mettā... (viharati), (p. 25)
3. iti mayhañ ca avihesā **bhavissati**...
   For me **there will be** no trouble... (bhavati), (p. 27)
4. ariyaṃ aṭṭh'aṅgikaṃ maggaṃ **bhāvessati**...
   He will develop the Noble Eightfold Path... (bhāveti), (p. 34)
5. bhagavato sutvā, bhikkhū **dhāressanti**...
   Having heard it from the Blessed One, the bhikkhus **will remember** it... (dhāreti), (p. 35)
6. tena hi, bhikkhave, suṇātha, sādhukaṃ manasi karotha, **bhāsissāmi**...
   Then listen, bhikkhus, and attend closely, **I will speak**... (bhāsati), (p. 35)
7. yaṃ kammaṃ **karissāmi** — kalyāṇaṃ vā pāpakaṃ vā — tassa dāyādo **bhavissāmi**.
   Whatever kamma **I will do**, good or bad, of that **I will be** the heir... (karoti, bhavati), (p. 40)

8. taṃ vo pahīnaṃ, hitāya sukhāya **bhavissati**.
   When it has been let go of by you, [it] **will be** for your welfare and happiness... (bhavati), (p. 52)
9. sabbaṃ vo, bhikkhave, **desessāmi**.
   Bhikkhus, **I will teach** you the all... (deseti), (p. 56)
10. aññaṃ sabbaṃ **paññāpessāmi**...
    I shall make known another all... (paññapeti), (p. 56)
11. diṭṭhe diṭṭha-mattaṃ **bhavissati**...
    In the seen **there will be** merely the seen... (bhavati), (p. 59)
12. paṭicca-samuppādaṃ vo, bhikkhave, **desessāmi**...
    Bhikkhus, **I will teach** you dependent origination... (deseti), (p. 74)
13. satipaṭṭhānañ ca vo, bhikkhave, **desessāmi**...
    Bhikkhus, **I will teach** you the establishment of awareness... (deseti), (p. 99)
14. asaṅkhatañ ca vo, bhikkhave, **desessāmi**...
    Bhikkhus, **I will teach** you the unconditioned... (deseti), (p. 105)

Participles

- A participle is a word derived from a verb that retains some verbal qualities but can function in various ways, often as an adjective.
  As such, it is declined in all three genders and **must agree with the noun it describes** in **gender, number, and case**.

The Past Participle (ta / na)

Use:

The Past Participle (pp) is a verbal form that expresses a completed action.
It often describes a noun that has undergone the action, and is typically passive in meaning.

Past Participles in English often end in -***ed***:
closed, cleaned, relaxed, cooked, washed, printed
Or -***en***:
eaten, frozen, forgotten, written, broken, spoken, chosen

Formation:

The Past Participle is usually formed by adding the endings ***(i)ta*/*na*** to the root of the verb (*gacchati* → √*gam*), often with some changes to the root (√*ga**m*** → *gata*).

gata – *gone*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	gat**o**	gat**ā**	gat**aṃ**	gat**āni**	gat**ā**	gat**ā**
Accusative	gat**aṃ**	gat**e**	gat**aṃ**	gat**āni** / gat**e**	gat**aṃ**	gat**ā**
Instrumental	gat**ena**	gat**ehi**	gat**ena**	gat**ehi**	gat**āya**	gat**āhi**
Dative	gat**assa** / gat**āya**	gat**ānaṃ**	gat**assa** / gat**āya**	gat**ānaṃ**	gat**āya**	gat**ānaṃ**
Ablative	ga**to** / gat**ā**	gat**ehi**	gat**ā**	gat**ehi**	gat**āya**	gat**āhi**
Genitive	gat**ssa**	gat**ānaṃ**	gat**ssa**	gat**ānaṃ**	gat**āya**	gat**ānaṃ**
Locative	gat**e**	gat**esu**	gat**e**	gat**esu**	gat**āya**	gat**āsu**
Vocative	gat**a**	gat**ā**	gat**a**	gat**āni**	gat**e**	gat**ā**

More Past Participles:

samāhita (concentrated), **kata** (done), **nisinna** (seated), **sampanno** (accomplished), **paṭipanna** (practised), **desita** (taught), **suta** (heard), **phuṭṭha** (touched), **paṭivirata** (abstained), **pahīna** (abandoned), **bhāvita** (developed), **sikkhita** (trained), **uppanna** (arisen), **vippamutta** (liberated), **vidita** (known), **paccupaṭṭhita** (established), **bhāsita** (spoken)

The Present Participle (anta / māna)

Use:

The Present Participle (prp) is a verbal form that expresses an action that is currently happening or ongoing. It often describes a noun that is performing the action, and is typically active in meaning.

Present Participles in English end in -***ing*** :
going, seeing, doing, speaking, eating, walking, sitting

Formation:

The Present Participle is usually formed by adding the ending ***anta*** /***māna*** to the stem of the verb (*gacchati* → *gaccha*).

The following paradigm shows only the ***anta*** endings.
The ***māna*** forms follow a very similar declension pattern (gaccha**māno**, gaccha**mānaṃ**, etc.).

gacchanta / gacchamāna – *going*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	gacch**anto** / gacch**aṃ**	gacch**antā**	gacch**aṃ**	gacch**antā** / gacch**antāni**	gacch**antī**	gacch**antī**
Accusative	gacch**antaṃ**	gacch**ante**	gacch**antaṃ**	gacch**antāni** / gacch**ante**	gacch**antiṃ**	gacch**antī**
Instrumental	gacch**atā** / gacch**antena**	gacch**antehi**	gacch**atā** / gacch**antena**	gacch**antehi**	gacch**antiyā**	gacch**antīhi**
Dative	gacch**ato** / gacch**antassa**	gacch**ataṃ** / gacch**antānaṃ**	gacch**ato** / gacch**antassa**	gacch**ataṃ** / gacch**antānaṃ**	gacch**antiyā**	gacch**antīnaṃ**
Ablative	gacch**atā** / gacch**antasmā**	gacch**antehi**	gacch**atā** / gacch**antasmā**	gacch**antehi**	gacch**antiyā**	gacch**antīhi**
Genitive	gacch**ato** / gacch**antassa**	gacch**ataṃ** / gacch**antānaṃ**	gacch**ato** / gacch**antassa**	gacch**ataṃ** / gacch**antānaṃ**	gacch**antiyā**	gacch**antīnaṃ**
Locative	gacch**antasmiṃ** / gacch**ante**	gacch**antesu**	gacch**antasmiṃ** / gacch**ante**	gacch**antesu**	gacch**antiyā**	gacch**antīsu**

More Present Participles:

jānanta (knowing), **passanta** (seeing), **vediyamāna** (feeling; experiencing),
appajānanta (not knowing), **abhinandanta** (delighting), **nijjhāyanta** (examining),
upaparikkhanta (investigating), **gavesanta** (searching), **viheṭhayanta** (harming),
sampassanta (looking; regarding), **assasanta** (breathing in), **passasanta** (breathing out)

The Future Passive Participle (tabba / anīya)

Use:

The Future Passive Participle (also known as the *Potential Participle*, ptp)
is a verbal form that expresses something that **should** or **is to be done** in the future
(somewhat similar in meaning to the Optative).
It generally indicates that an action is **recommended** or **required**, and has a **passive** meaning.

It is often translated with "**to be**" + a **past participle**:
to be done, to be said, to be known, etc.

Formation:

The Future Passive Participle is most often formed by adding the affixes ***tabba*** /***anīya*** to the stem of the verb (*gacchati* → *gaccha*), or its root (*gacchati* → √*gam*).

gan**tabba** / gam**anīya** – *to be gone*

Case	Masculine		Neuter		Feminine	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Nominative	gan**tabbo** / gam**anīyo**	gan**tabbā** / gam**anīyā**	gan**tabbaṃ** / gam**anīyaṃ**	gan**tabbāni** / gam**anīyā**	gan**tabbā** / gam**anīyā**	gan**tabbā** / gam**anīyā**
Accusative	gan**tabbaṃ** / gam**anīyaṃ**	gan**tabbe** / gam**anīye**	gan**tabbaṃ** / gam**anīyaṃ**	gan**tabbāni** / gan**tabbe** / gam**anīye**	gan**tabbaṃ** / gam**anīyaṃ**	gan**tabbā** / gam**anīyā**

The rest of the declensions are similar to those of the Present Participle.

More Future Passive Participles:

veditabba (to be experienced), **karaṇīya** (to be done), **pūjanīya** (to be venerated), **sikkhitabba** (to be trained), **upaparikkhitabba** (to be examined), **atimaññitabba** (to be underestimated), **paccavekkhitabba** (to be reflected), **pahātabba** (to be abandoned), **sacchi-kātabba** (to be personally realized), **bhāvetabba** (to be developed), **daṭṭhabba** (to be seen), **vacanīya** (to be said), **pariññeyya** (to be fully understood - irrg.)

Adverbs (aṃ / ena)

- An adverb describes **how**, **when**, **where**, or **to what extent** something happens. It most often modifies a verb, but can also describe adjectives or other adverbs. Examples: speaks **kindly**, waits **patiently**, comes **often**.

- Adverbs are **indeclinable**, meaning they do not change according to case, gender, or number, but remain in the same form.

    - Adverbs in Pāḷi often end in -***aṃ*** /-***ena***:
      evaṃ (thus), **sukhaṃ** (happily), **sādhukaṃ** (well; carefully), **bahulaṃ** (often), **khemaṃ** (safely), **abhiṇhaṃ** (frequently), **saṅkhittena** (briefly), **kālena** (timely)

      But also:
      sammā (fully; rightly), **idha** (here), **yattha** (where), **tattha** (there), **yadā** (when), **tadā** (then)